PITCH DECK | CIENA ADVISOR, COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE - INSIDE-THE-DATA-CENTER TECHNOLOGIES

Competitive intelligence only earns its keep if it changes a decision before a rival ships. I already run that loop on hardware markets just as technical as yours.

Competitive benchmarking tied to a revenue outcome, structured market sizing, and AI tools built into the research workflow today, not as a pilot.

- **+12% YoY revenue, +8% share** from benchmarking 10+ competitors at Sensata and repricing against their moves
- **10+ competitors, 150+ facilities** assessed for Safran's market-entry case, briefed directly to their leadership
- **$433M** in margin gaps surfaced from a dashboard I built for leadership to act on
- **Claude AI agents** automate my recurring research and briefing work today, at Applied Materials
- **Semiconductor market sizing** with Sales, Engineering and Accounts, the same multi-stakeholder loop as Sales, PLM and the CTO office

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WHY THIS DECK EXISTS

Competitive intelligence that sits in a slide deck is a history lesson. Competitive intelligence that reaches Sales, PLM and the CTO office before the next launch is a weapon.

What a fast-moving, technical hardware market does to a CI function

Signal on a rival's next move in AI cluster architectures, coherent optics or pluggable optics arrives in pieces, from Sales, Marketing, PLM, the CTO office and R&D, each with their own angle and urgency.

Without one person owning the synthesis, battlecards go stale, messaging drifts between teams, and the briefing reaches an executive after the decision window, not before it.

The fix is not another one-off competitor slide. It is one analyst who owns the synthesis, keeps the briefing current, and ties every finding back to a decision someone is about to make.

What I have already run, hands on

At **Sensata**, I benchmarked 10+ competitors across the Industrial BU and turned the findings into a repricing call that drove +12% YoY revenue and +8% market share, not a report that sat unread.

At **Applied Materials**, I size a fast-moving technical market with Sales, Engineering and Accounts, the same cross-functional input loop this role runs with Sales, Marketing, PLM, CTO and R&D.

At **Safran**, I led a 5-consultant team that benchmarked 10+ competitors across 150+ facilities and briefed the result straight to leadership.

Analyze competitors' strategy and moves, align messaging across Sales, Marketing, PLM, CTO and R&D, and produce briefings that get acted on: this is the exact loop I already run, just on a different hardware category.

THE REQ, MAPPED

What the Advisor, Competitive Intelligence opening asks for, and where the proof sits.

What the role covers

> *"Leads competitive efforts on Inside-the-Data-Center (ITDC) technologies: AI cluster architectures, coherent optics, pluggable optics, SerDes, silicon photonics."*

> *"Analyzes competitors' strategy and moves."*

> *"Supports Sales, Marketing, PLM, CTO and R&D with competitive intelligence; aligns messaging."*

> *"Produces briefings and content, uses AI tools for content development."*

My Proof

Sensata competitive benchmarking: 10+ players tracked and turned into a repricing recommendation that drove +12% YoY revenue and +8% market share.

Applied Materials market sizing: semiconductor market sized with Sales, Engineering and Accounts, the same multi-stakeholder input this req runs across Sales, Marketing, PLM, CTO and R&D.

Safran market-entry briefing: 10+ competitors and 150+ facilities assessed, with the recommendation presented directly to leadership.

AI tooling for content: recurring research and briefing work already automated with AI agents built on Claude at Applied Materials.

THE SENSATA PROOF, IN DEPTH

One benchmarking program, one repricing call, a revenue and share number leadership could point to.

The Bleeders and Leakers program benchmarked 10+ key players across the Industrial BU, then used the competitive gaps and customer willingness-to-pay data underneath that benchmarking to decide where to reprice. It was not filed as a report; it ran as the input to an actual pricing call.

10+

Competitors Benchmarked

Tracked across the Industrial BU to find where competitive gaps and customer willingness-to-pay data pointed to a repricing opportunity.

+12% YoY

Revenue Driven

From price realignment informed directly by that competitive read, not a separate decision made later.

+8 pts

Market Share Gained

The business outcome of acting on the competitive benchmarking, the same bar a CI briefing should clear.

The common thread: track the competitors, tie the finding to a decision someone is about to make, then close the loop by measuring what happened after. That is the same loop I would bring to Ciena's ITDC competitive coverage.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE, ON A REALISTIC TIMELINE

How I would ramp into ITDC coverage without losing momentum on day one.

3 MONTHS

ITDC landscape mapped, first briefings shipped

Apply the same structured-sizing method behind the Safran engagement to map the named rivals in AI cluster architectures, coherent optics and pluggable optics, and ship the first set of briefings aligned with Sales and PLM.

Why this is realistic: it is the same opening move as Safran: assess the landscape and competitors first, then brief leadership on what it means.

6 MONTHS

Monitoring cadence running, content automated

Stand up a recurring competitive-monitoring cadence across the named rivals, and automate the repetitive research and content pulls with AI tooling, freeing time for the synthesis that actually needs judgment.

Why now: the same automate-then-synthesize sequence Claude agents already run for me at Applied Materials.

12 MONTHS

The team's go-to before a competitive move needs a response

Be the person Sales, Marketing, PLM, the CTO office and R&D route to before reacting to a rival's launch, with messaging alignment measurably faster than it was on day one.

Why this sticks: the same trust the Sensata benchmarking earned once it moved revenue and share, not just a slide.

CLOSE

You are hiring someone to turn ITDC competitive signal into briefings that change a decision. I have already run that exact loop, on a different, equally technical hardware market.

The core proof is Sensata: **10+ competitors benchmarked** into a repricing call that drove **+12% YoY revenue and +8% market share**, plus a 5-consultant Safran engagement that briefed 10+ competitors and 150+ facilities straight to leadership.

What is harder to find is someone who already automates the recurring part of that research with the same AI tools your posting names for content development. I run that today at Applied Materials, which means the habit this role asks for is not something I would need to build on the job.

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